

WhatsApp Order Update Automation

Architecture, Cost, Requirements, Timeline, Team and Feasibility

Client: House Of Sandhya

Use case: Shopify order placed -> 2-day reminders until shipped

Plus: shipment confirmation and tracking updates

Approach: Custom WhatsApp Cloud API app with Shopify integration

Prepared: 16 July 2026

Note: Exact WhatsApp rates must be confirmed in Meta's live pricing calculator before production.

1. Executive Summary

Project feasible hai. Custom WhatsApp app ban sakta hai jo Shopify/GoKwik order create hone ke baad customer ko automated WhatsApp order-status updates bheje. SMS Alert jaisi monthly app dependency kam hogi, lekin Meta WhatsApp Business Platform ka per-delivered-message charge fir bhi lagega.

Recommended route: Pehle MVP build karo: order created webhook, 2/4/6 day unfulfilled reminders, shipped/tracking message, logs, retries. Courier live tracking ke liye phase 2 me Shiprocket/AfterShip webhook add karo.

Item	MVP Estimate	Production Estimate
Build timeline	7-12 working days	3-5 weeks
One-time development	INR 60,000 - INR 120,000	INR 150,000 - INR 350,000
Monthly hosting/tools	INR 800 - INR 3,000	INR 3,000 - INR 12,000
Meta WhatsApp messages	Approx INR 0.10 - 0.25 per delivered Utility message, final rate live Meta calculator se confirm	Same; volume tiers may reduce rate
Feasibility	High	High, if Meta templates + phone setup approved

2. User Flow

Target automation:

- Shopify/GoKwik order placed -> app receives webhook.
- App schedules reminder jobs at day 2, day 4, and day 6.
- Each reminder se pehle app Shopify se latest fulfillment status check karega.
- Agar order unfulfilled hai, WhatsApp Utility template message send hoga.
- Jab order shipped/fulfilled ho, tracking ID/link wala WhatsApp message send hoga.
- Agar courier live events chahiye, Shiprocket/AfterShip webhook se in-transit, out-for-delivery, delivered updates send honge.

3. Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Why
Backend API	Node.js + Express/NestJS	Shopify webhooks, Meta API calls, easy deployment
Database	PostgreSQL via Supabase/Neon/Railway	Orders, scheduled jobs, logs, delivery status
Queue/Scheduler	BullMQ + Redis or cloud cron	2-day/4-day/6-day delayed jobs reliably run karne ke liye
Shopify integration	Shopify Admin API + webhooks	orders/create, fulfillments/create, cancellations, order status checks
WhatsApp	Meta WhatsApp Cloud API	Direct API, BSP monthly plan ki zarurat nahi
Hosting	Render/Railway/Fly.io/VPS	Low-cost Node hosting with HTTPS
Monitoring	Sentry + uptime monitor	Failures, retries, webhook issues catch karne ke liye
Optional courier	Shiprocket/AfterShip API/webhooks	Live shipment tracking updates

4. Requirements and Approvals

Requirement	Needed?	Notes
Meta Business Manager	Yes	Business portfolio ke naam se setup
WhatsApp Business Account (WABA)	Yes	Meta Business settings me create hoga
Dedicated phone number	Yes	Cloud API me register; existing WhatsApp app number usually direct use nahi hota unless migrated
Display name approval	Yes	Example: House Of Sandhya
Message template approval	Yes	Order updates Utility category me submit honge
Billing/payment method	Yes	Meta per delivered message charge karega
Customer consent	Recommended/ required by policy	Checkout/privacy policy me WhatsApp order updates consent mention karna
SMS DLT	No	WhatsApp ke liye SMS DLT/header required nahi
Separate WhatsApp license	No	Platform access free; usage charges apply

5. Message Templates

Templates Meta me approve karwani hongi. Proposed category: Utility.

Template name	Message
order_processing_update	Hi {{1}}, your order {{2}} is currently being prepared and processed. We will notify you once it is shipped. - House Of Sandhya
order_quality_check	Update: Your order {{1}} is in process and quality check. Thanks for your patience. - House Of Sandhya
order_ready_dispatch	Your order {{1}} is almost ready for dispatch. We will share tracking details as soon as it ships. - House Of Sandhya
order_shipped_tracking	Good news! Your order {{1}} has been shipped. Tracking ID: {{2}}. Track here: {{3}} - House Of Sandhya

6. Cost Calculation

Meta official pricing page ke hisaab se WhatsApp Business Platform par charge delivered message par lagta hai, sent message par nahi. Rate recipient market aur message category ke hisaab se vary karta hai. For this project, messages Utility category me aane chahiye.

Monthly orders	Messages/order	Delivered msgs/month	Meta cost @ INR 0.12	Meta cost @ INR 0.25
500	4	2,000	INR 240	INR 500
1,000	4	4,000	INR 480	INR 1,000
3,000	4	12,000	INR 1,440	INR 3,000
10,000	4	40,000	INR 4,800	INR 10,000

Note: INR 0.12 - 0.25 per Utility message is a planning range for India. Final rate Meta pricing calculator/rate card se confirm hoga, and may change by date, volume tier, and category.

7. One-time and Monthly Budget

Cost head	MVP	Production grade
Planning + Meta setup guidance	INR 10,000 - INR 20,000	INR 20,000 - INR 40,000
Backend + Shopify webhooks	INR 25,000 - INR 45,000	INR 60,000 - INR 120,000
WhatsApp API integration	INR 15,000 - INR 30,000	INR 40,000 - INR 80,000
Scheduler + retries + logs	INR 15,000 - INR 25,000	INR 40,000 - INR 80,000
Admin dashboard	Basic logs included	INR 30,000 - INR 70,000
Courier tracking integration	Not included or basic Shopify fulfillment only	INR 30,000 - INR 80,000
QA/testing/deployment	INR 10,000 - INR 20,000	INR 30,000 - INR 60,000
Total one-time	INR 60,000 - INR 120,000	INR 150,000 - INR 350,000

Monthly cost head	Expected amount
Server hosting	INR 500 - INR 3,000 for MVP
Database/Redis	Free - INR 1,500 initially
Monitoring/logging	Free - INR 1,000
Meta WhatsApp usage	Depends on delivered messages; example 4,000 utility msgs/month = approx INR 480 - INR 1,000 planning range
Maintenance	INR 5,000 - INR 25,000 / month depending on support SLA

8. Team and Specializations Needed

Role	Need	Effort
Backend developer	Required	Main implementation: APIs, webhooks, queue, database
Shopify developer	Required/part-time	Shopify app credentials, webhooks, Admin API scopes
Meta/WhatsApp setup person	Required/part-time	Business Manager, WABA, phone, templates, billing
QA tester	Required/part-time	Test orders, failed cases, duplicate sends, cancellation/fulfillment scenarios
DevOps/hosting	Can be backend dev	Deploy, environment variables, SSL, monitoring
Support person	Optional	Daily logs and failed-message checks

9. Timeline and Effort

Phase	Duration	Output
Discovery + exact flow finalization	0.5 - 1 day	Message schedule, templates, data fields, opt-in wording
Meta account/WABA/phone setup	1 - 3 days	Can run parallel; approval delays possible
Template submission/approval	1 - 5 days	Depends on Meta review
Backend MVP build	4 - 7 days	Webhook receiver, DB, scheduler, WhatsApp send

Phase	Duration	Output
Testing with Shopify test orders	1 - 2 days	Logs, retries, duplicate prevention
Deployment + go-live	0.5 - 1 day	Production app live
Courier live tracking phase	3 - 7 days extra	Shiprocket/AfterShip webhooks and messages

Total MVP: 7-12 working days if Meta setup is smooth. Production-grade: 3-5 weeks.

10. Risks and Controls

Risk	Impact	Control
Template rejected	Messages cannot send	Keep messages non-promotional; Utility category; clear order context
Duplicate messages	Bad customer experience	Idempotency key per order + template + scheduled day
Order shipped before scheduled WhatsApp	Wrong message	Always re-check Shopify fulfillment status before sending
Phone number missing/invalid	Message fails	Validate E.164 phone format; fallback logs
Meta rate/category changes	Cost changes	Monthly review of Meta pricing
Courier data missing	No tracking updates	Phase 2 integration with Shiprocket/AfterShip

11. Final Recommendation

Setup possible hai and technically straightforward hai. Sabse practical plan: first MVP direct Meta WhatsApp Cloud API se banao, SMS Alert dependency remove karo, and sirf Utility order updates send karo. Marketing/promotional WhatsApp messages ko alag rakho, kyunki marketing category ka cost zyada hota hai aur approval stricter ho sakta hai.

Decision point: agar immediate low-effort launch chahiye to WATI/Interakt/AiSensy jaisa BSP fast hoga but monthly plan lagega. Agar long-term control and lower platform cost chahiye, custom Cloud API app better hai.

12. References

1. WhatsApp Business Platform Pricing: <https://whatsappbusiness.com/products/platform-pricing/>
2. Meta WhatsApp Cloud API get started: <https://developers.facebook.com/docs/whatsapp/cloud-api/get-started/>
3. Meta WhatsApp message templates: <https://developers.facebook.com/docs/whatsapp/business-management-api/message-templates/>
4. Shopify webhooks: <https://shopify.dev/docs/api/webhooks/latest>